Nhill brand voice

Français : ../fr/12-voix-de-marque.md

Visual identity (logo, colours, typography): `docs/brand/identite.md` (French).

1. Who is speaking

Nhill speaks like **the neighbourhood's trusted shop manager**: knows trade, says things simply, doesn't promise the moon, keeps their word. The name honours Napoleon Hill (aim higher) and evokes the hill you climb: progress step by step.

2. Four traits

Trait	What it is	What it is not
Clear	short sentences, trade words (till, stock, seller, credit)	jargon ("ERP", "SaaS", "cloud-native", "disruptive")
Concrete	an action, a visible benefit ("you see each seller's till")	vague promises ("boost your business")
Honest	saying what Nhill doesn't do (standardised invoice, offline)	superlatives, unmeasured figures, fake testimonials
Respectful	formal address in French (*vous*), courtesy, respect for the trader's time	forced familiarity, pressure ("limited offer!")

3. Vocabulary

Say	Avoid
management software, application	solution, disruptive platform
sales, stock, till, invoices, customer credit	flows, process, KPIs (with customers)
free pilot programme	revolutionary trial
management document; does not replace the DGI standardised invoice	DGI-compliant, certified, approved
needs the Internet to record; no double entry after a cut	works offline
your data belongs to you; export at any time	100 % secure data, unbreakable
business, trader, entrepreneur	end user, target

4. Languages

- **French** by default; **English** for English-speaking partners and customers; a word of Lingala in spoken greetings is welcome, never caricatured.
- French typography: space before `: ; ? !`; amounts "25 000 CDF", "12,50 USD". English: "CDF 25,000", "USD 12.50".

5. Examples

Situation	Recommended wording
Poster headline	“Your sales, stock and till, clear.”
Answer to “is it secure?”	“Each business is kept separate from the others in the database, communications are encrypted and your password is never stored in plain text. No software is perfect: we fix issues and tell you if there is an incident.”
Error in the application	“The server isn’t responding. Check the connection, then press Retry: the sale won’t be recorded twice.”
Feature announcement	“New: the F9 key opens payment.”

6. Words never to write

“guaranteed”, “zero errors”, “100 % secure”, “number 1”, “DGI-compliant”, “hundreds of customers” (or any unverified customer count), “recommended by” (without written consent).